

OpenEMR Integration

What the AI can do

Summary

OpenEMR Integration connects **OpenEMR** (open-source electronic health records and medical practice management system) with **Newo Platform**.

It enables:

- Checking available appointment slots for a selected provider and facility
- Booking appointments with automatic patient record search and creation
- Cancelling existing appointments
- Pre-configured facility and provider selection during setup
- OAuth2 token management with automatic refresh on expiration

This integration is designed for **medical practices and clinics using OpenEMR** who need **automated appointment scheduling through a conversational AI agent** (voice or chat).

Common use cases

- When a patient asks about available slots -> AI checks the configured provider's schedule and returns open time slots
- When a patient wants to book an appointment -> Search or create patient record, then create appointment in OpenEMR
- When a patient wants to cancel an appointment -> Delete the appointment via OpenEMR API
- When a new patient books -> Automatically create patient record in OpenEMR before booking
- When the project is published -> Facilities and providers are fetched and stored for selection

Features at a glance

Feature	Supported	Notes
Check Availability	Yes	Date range lookup for selected provider and facility
Book Appointment	Yes	With automatic patient creation if needed
Cancel Appointment	Yes	Requires booking_id and contact_id from prior booking
Facility Selection	Yes	Pre-configured during setup via enum attribute
Provider Selection	Yes	Pre-configured during setup, filtered by facility
Patient Search	Yes	By phone number via OpenEMR API
Patient Creation	Yes	Auto-creates during booking flow
Token Auto-Refresh	Yes	OAuth2 with password grant and refresh token rotation
Multi-Provider Scheduling	No	Single provider selected during setup
Reschedule Appointment	No	Cancel + rebook as workaround
Historical Data Import	No	Only new events after activation

Before You Start

Before installation:

- Active **OpenEMR** instance with REST API enabled
- **OAuth2 Client ID** and **Client Secret** registered in OpenEMR
- **Username**, **password**, and **email** for an OpenEMR user with API access
- The OpenEMR instance must be accessible via HTTPS from the platform

Setup

Create the Newo project

If this project already exists in **Newo Builder**, skip this subsection and continue with the integration-specific settings below.

1. In **Newo Builder**, open the projects list and click **Create Project** (or **Create New Project** from the top-right menu).



Create New Project menu in Newo Builder

2. Fill **IDN** and **Title**. The exact names do not matter; use any clear names your team will recognize.
3. In **Registry**, choose the release channel:
 - **staging** — the newest module fixes appear here first. Use it when you need the latest fix, but expect possible unfinished changes.
 - **production** — the final stable version for live projects.
4. In **Module**, select the module for this integration.



Create Project form showing IDN, Title, Registry, and Module fields 5. Leave **Module version** on **Latest**

version unless support tells you to pin a specific version, then click **Create**.

3.1 Step 1 — Get API Credentials

1. Log in to your **OpenEMR** instance as an administrator
2. Navigate to **Administration -> System -> API Clients**
3. Register a new OAuth2 client application
4. Note the **Client ID** and **Client Secret**
5. Ensure the API user has appropriate permissions for appointments and patient management

3.2 Step 2 — Connect in Platform

1. Open **Newo -> Projects**
2. Set the following attributes in **Builder / Attributes**:

Attribute	Required	Description
openemr_base_url	Yes	Base URL of your OpenEMR instance (e.g., <code>https://emr.example.com</code>)
openemr_client_id	Yes	OAuth2 Client ID
openemr_client_secret	Yes	OAuth2 Client Secret

openemr_username	Yes	OpenEMR user username for API access
openemr_password	Yes	OpenEMR user password
openemr_email	Yes	OpenEMR user email
openemr_scope	No	OAuth2 scopes (pre-configured with full access)
openemr_facility	No	Selected facility (auto-populated during setup)
openemr_provider	No	Selected provider (auto-populated during setup)
openemr_enable_slot_check	No	Enable availability checks (default: True)
openemr_enable_booking	No	Enable appointment creation (default: True)
openemr_enable_cancellation	No	Enable cancellations (default: True)
openemr_check_existing_client	No	Check if patient exists before creating (default: True)
openemr_show_for_days	No	Number of days to check for availability
openemr_override_agent_attributes	No	Override SuperAgent attribute schemas (default: True)

3. Click **Save + Publish All**

4. On publish, the SetupFlow automatically:

- Exchanges credentials for an OAuth2 access token (password grant)
- Prepares the connections for API and token operations
- Fetches all facilities and populates the facility selector
- Fetches providers for the selected facility and populates the provider selector
- Registers availability, booking, and cancellation tools with the agent
- Injects payload schemas for the ConvoAgent tool calling framework

How to use the integration

This section explains how the integration works, how to configure automation, and how to test it.

4.1 How the Integration Works

The integration uses OpenEMR's REST API for appointment management, patient records, and facility data. Unlike multi-provider integrations, the facility and provider are pre-selected during setup, simplifying runtime slot lookups. The OAuth2 token is auto-refreshed on 401 responses using the refresh token grant.

- A **Trigger** is a system event that starts a flow
- An **Action** is the API operation performed in OpenEMR

Where to test

Testing can be done through the **Newo conversation interface** (voice or chat). Each flow (Availability, Booking, Cancellation) has a dedicated webhook test endpoint for connectivity validation.

How to test that everything works

To test the integration:

1. **Setup:** Publish the project and verify token exchange succeeds (check `openemr_access_token` is populated)
2. **Facilities:** After publish, verify `openemr_facility` enum is populated with your clinics
3. **Providers:** Verify `openemr_provider` enum shows providers for the selected facility
4. **Availability:** Ask "What slots are available on Monday?" — verify slots returned with correct times
5. **Booking:** Complete a booking conversation — verify appointment appears in OpenEMR calendar
6. **Cancellation:** Request cancellation of a booked appointment — verify appointment removed from OpenEMR

If no action occurs:

- Ensure `openemr_base_url`, `openemr_client_id`, and `openemr_client_secret` are set correctly
- Verify `openemr_username`, `openemr_password`, and `openemr_email` are valid OpenEMR credentials
- Confirm `openemr_access_token` was obtained (check it's not empty after setup)
- Ensure the relevant feature flags are enabled (`openemr_enable_booking`, `openemr_enable_slot_check`, `openemr_enable_cancellation`)
- Verify `openemr_facility` and `openemr_provider` were populated during setup
- Check that OpenEMR's REST API is enabled and accessible from the platform
- Re-publish the project if credentials were changed

Note: This integration performs real operations in OpenEMR. Appointments created or cancelled through the agent are reflected in the live OpenEMR system.

FAQ

Q: How does facility and provider selection work? A: Unlike multi-provider integrations, OpenEMR uses a pre-selection model. During setup, all facilities are fetched and presented as an enum dropdown. After selecting a facility, providers for that facility are fetched and presented similarly. These selections are stored and used for all subsequent availability checks and bookings.

Q: What patient information is required for booking? A: First name, last name, date of birth (YYYY-MM-DD), sex (Male/Female), and phone number are required. Middle name is optional. If the phone number is not available, the agent will request it before proceeding.

Q: What happens if the OAuth token expires? A: The UtilsFlow automatically detects 401 responses. If a refresh token is available, it uses the `refresh_token` grant to obtain a new access token. If no refresh token exists, it falls back to the `password` grant using the stored credentials. The original request is retried up to 3 times.

Q: How many days of availability does the agent check? A: Configurable via the `openemr_show_for_days` attribute. The API call checks from the requested date through the configured number of days.

Q: What is the default appointment duration? A: 15 minutes. All appointments are created with `pc_duration: 15` and the end time is calculated as start time + 15 minutes. The appointment title defaults to "Office Visit".

Q: Does the integration support multiple facilities simultaneously? A: No. A single facility and provider are selected during setup. To switch facilities, update the `openemr_facility` attribute and re-publish the project to refresh the provider list.

Q: What OAuth2 scopes are required? A: The integration pre-configures a comprehensive scope set covering appointments, patients, practitioners, locations, and related resources. The scope attribute is auto-populated during setup and typically does not need manual configuration.